Dream *Wedding*
BUILDER

The Wedding Vows Workbook

From a blank page to vows you can say out loud.

WHAT IS INSIDE

- Decide the basics together
- Memory and promise prompts
- A five-part structure
- Three fill-in templates
- Length and timing guide
- Read-aloud practice page
- Final vows cards

HOW TO USE THIS KIT

Before you start

Start with the basics page together, then write on your own. Use the prompts to collect material, the structure to put it in order, and a template if you want a head start.

Write a messy first draft, put it away for a day, then cut. Most vows get better by getting shorter.

If your officiant or venue has guidance on vow length or content, follow it.

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Questions: info@weddingchecklistpdf.com

BEFORE EITHER OF YOU WRITES

Decide the basics together

Roughly how long will each set of vows be? (for example, one minute each)

What tone: funny, serious, or both?

Will we share them before the day, or keep them a surprise?

Same format (both personal, or both traditional), or different?

Who will hold the cards on the day, and who reads first?

Anything off limits (old relationships, private jokes, family topics)?

COLLECT MATERIAL FIRST

Prompts: remember

Answer quickly, in a few words. You will not use all of it.

When did you first know this was different?

A small everyday moment you love:

Something they do that makes you laugh:

A hard time you got through together:

What they have taught you:

How your life is different with them in it:

WHAT YOU ARE SAYING YES TO

Prompts: promise

A promise about how you will treat them on hard days:

A promise about something fun or silly:

A promise about the life you are building:

A promise about growing old together:

One line you want them to remember years from now:

PUT IT IN ORDER

A five-part structure

1. Open

Say their name and one sentence that sets the tone.

2. A story

One short moment from your prompts that shows who they are, or who you are together.

3. What you love

Two or three specific things. Specific beats general.

4. Your promises

Three to five promises, from serious to light, or the other way round.

5. Close

A last line that ties back to the opening and hands the moment over.

FILL IN THE BLANKS

Template 1: classic

_____, from the day _____, I knew

_____.

I love the way you _____ and how you

_____.

Today I promise to _____, to

_____, and to _____.

I promise to _____ even when

_____.

I choose you, today and every day after. _____.

START WITH ONE MOMENT

Template 2: story-led

_____, I keep coming back to one moment:

_____.

That was when I saw that you _____.

Since then you have taught me _____, and made

_____ feel like home.

So here is what I promise: _____.

_____. And _____.

Whatever comes next, _____.

ABOUT THIRTY SECONDS

Template 3: short and sweet

_____, you are _____.

I promise to _____ and to

_____.

I will always _____. I love you.

Short vows land best when every word is specific. Swap any general word for a real detail.

HOW LONG IS LONG ENOUGH

Length and timing

Most people speak about 120 to 150 words a minute when they read aloud slowly and clearly, as you will at a ceremony. Use the table as a rough guide, then time yourself on the practice page.

Spoken length	About how many words	Feels like
30 seconds	60 to 75	A short, punchy promise
1 minute	120 to 150	Most personal vows
2 minutes	240 to 300	A story and promises
3 minutes	360 to 450	Long: check with your partner

My word count: _____ Partner's target: _____

Agree on a target together so one set of vows is not three times as long as the other.

SAY IT, TIME IT, CUT IT

Read-aloud practice

Read your vows out loud at least three times before the day. Mark where you stumble and cut or simplify those lines.

Date	Time taken	Where I stumbled	What I cut or changed

- [ ] Final version read aloud to a mirror or a friend
- [ ] Card written in large, clear writing
- [ ] Card given to the person holding it on the day

CUT OUT AND KEEP

Final vows cards

MY VOWS

MY VOWS